

Daily Need to Know

Wednesday, 16 September 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
US CASH EQUITIES — SETTLED 16:00 ET TUESDAY, 2H 07M BEFORE CAPTURE			
S&P 500	7,585.73	▼ 34.25 · -0.45%	Range 7,572.69–7,617.26. Opened 7,612.30 and closed in the bottom third , 13.0 points off the low. Sits at 17.5% of Hedgeye's 7,551–7,750 band and still below the 7,656 gamma-flip line this brief carried on Monday.
Nasdaq Composite	25,981.57	▼ 204.84 · -0.78%	Range 25,943.31–26,172.12; closed at 16.7% of the day's range . Now 9.5% of its risk range — the most floor-pinned index in the table, 66.6 points above a 25,915 floor that was raised 205 points last night.
Dow Jones	52,093.11	▼ 328.09 · -0.63%	Range 51,875.65–52,336.61. The only major to close near its mid-range. Volume 377m against a 10-day average of 401m — a 6% shortfall , so the decline was not distribution on size.
Russell 2000	2,870.29	▼ 21.95 · -0.76%	Closed 28% of range, 18.3 points above a 2,852 floor Hedgeye cut 16 points last night. Signal remains bearish TREND; small caps have now underperformed the S&P on four of the last five sessions.
Philadelphia SOX	11,175.54	▲ 44.26 · +0.40%	The only index green, and it closed in the bottom 27% of an 175-point range after trading 11,304.24. Up on the day, sold all day. SOXX +0.29%, SMH +0.11% confirm it.
INDEX FUTURES — DECEMBER CONTRACTS; TUESDAY GLOBEX SETTLE, THEN LIVE 13 MINUTES INTO THE NEW SESSION			
ES — E-mini S&P (Dec)	7,663.75	settle ▼ 36.75 · -0.48%	Settled 7,656.00 ; live 7,663.75 at 06:13:25, +7.75 (+0.10%) into the reopen. Basis to cash +70.3 (+0.93%) is December carry, not dislocation — the expiring September contract settled 7,589.25, just 3.5 over cash.
NQ — E-mini Nasdaq (Dec)	29,271.00	settle ▼ 202.75 · -0.69%	Settled 29,246.75 ; live +24.25 (+0.08%). Tracks NDX cash -0.65% to 28,937.84. September contract settled 28,955.00.
YM — E-mini Dow (Dec)	52,566	settle ▼ 335 · -0.63%	Settled 52,526 ; live +40 (+0.08%). Matches cash to a basis point — the cleanest futures/cash agreement in the table.
RTY — E-mini Russell (Dec)	2,896.80	settle ▼ 21.50 · -0.74%	Settled 2,894.70 ; live +2.10. December overtook September on volume between the two pulls — 275,363 lots against 167,426.
TREASURIES — CASH YIELDS, CLOSED 17:00 ET, 1H 07M BEFORE CAPTURE			
US 10-year	5.006%	▲ 0.8bp	The intraday 5.041% is a fresh 52-week high and the highest since 2007 . Sits at 84.8% of Hedgeye's 4.76–5.05% band; the high touched 96.9% . McCullough named 4.98% as the 2023 cycle high and 5.29% as the 2007 one — the first is now behind us.
US 30-year	5.369%	▲ 1.5bp	High 5.401%, within 2.3bp of the 5.424% 52-week high. The long end led again: 30s10s widened to 36.3bp .
US 5-year	4.837%	▲ 0.6bp	High 4.868%, 10bp under its own 52-week high. The belly is the one tenor not making new highs.
US 2-year	4.671%	▲ 0.3bp	Intraday 4.688% is itself a 52-week high , captured directly rather than inferred. 10s2s at 33.5bp : the curve steepened on the day because the long end sold harder, not because the front end rallied.
13-week bill	4.063%	▲ 1.2bp	Range 4.056–4.087%. 60bp below the 2-year — the bill market is not yet pricing what the note market is, 20 hours before the decision.
ENERGY — FRONT-MONTH FUTURES, TUESDAY SETTLE THEN LIVE IN THE NEW SESSION			
WTI crude (Oct)	\$105.49	settle ▲ 4.44 · +4.38%	The move of the day . Settled \$105.83 having traded 101.21–106.75; closed 96% of the way up its range, the exact opposite of Monday's rejection. Live 105.49, -0.32% into the reopen. 92.6% of Hedgeye's 91.35–106.98 band ; the high was 98.3%.
Brent (front)	\$108.55	settle ▲ 3.07 · +2.90%	Settled \$108.75 , range 105.11–109.45, closed 84% of range. WTI outpaced Brent by 148bp — the spread narrowed to \$2.92 , the tell that this is a waterborne-supply story reaching US grades.

Natural gas (Oct)	\$2.919	▲ 0.023 · +0.79%	Range 2.870-2.952. 74.6% of a 2.74-2.98 band Hedgeye cut to neutral on Monday. The 2.946 reopen print is on a single lot and is not a market.
RBOB gasoline (Oct)	\$3.4652	▲ 0.1481 · +4.47%	Outpaced crude. Range 3.3341-3.4771, closed 92% of range, fully reversing Monday's 4.1% break. The November contract at 3.2433 is winter-grade and is not comparable.
METALS — SPOT, THE SERIES HEDGEYE'S BANDS NAME; GENUINELY LIVE			
Gold — spot	\$4,294.11	live · +0.04%	\$4,295.39 at 06:07:25, \$4,294.11 at 06:13:25. Futures settled \$4,332.80, -0.44% — basis \$37.42 = 0.87% , so measure the band here. 39.0% of 4,229-4,399 , and \$100 below the \$4,395 TRADE line McCullough published this morning.
Silver — spot	\$63.700	live · +0.02%	Futures settled 63.856, -0.44%. 73.5% of a 60-65 band left unchanged overnight — the only instrument in the whole table whose band did not move. Hedgeye is flat silver, having sold SLV on last week's TREND break; SLV rose +1.21% .
Copper — spot	\$6.3568	live · +0.15%	Futures HG settled 6.4435, +0.61% . 48.8% of 6.19-6.53 — mid-band. On futures this row would misread 74.6%, a 26-point error.
CURRENCIES — DXY CARRIES THE TUESDAY STAMP; SPOT LEGS LIVE; ASIAN CROSSES ~15H OLD			
US Dollar Index	99.611	▲ 0.15%	Range 99.478-99.687. Identical across both pulls while every spot leg moved , so treat this as a settle, not a live print. 80.7% of a 98.78-99.81 band.
USD/JPY	155.121	live · -0.02%	Six-minute range 155.042-155.125 — eight-tenths of a yen of nothing . The day's change figure is a few minutes of trading and should not be read as direction. 8.9 yen below the 163.99 high.
USD/KRW	1,360.99	▲ 1.07%	Tuesday's Seoul close, ~15 hours old. The largest one-day won move in the capture universe and the single most important number for Asia's open. KOSPI fell 0.85% with the won down 1.07% — a classic foreign-outflow signature.
USD/TWD	31.9196	▲ 0.44%	Tuesday's Taipei close. Within 0.60 of the 32.52 52-week high. Korea and Taiwan weakened together, which is the semiconductor funding trade unwinding rather than two local stories.
VOLATILITY AND CRYPTO — VIX SETTLED; CRYPTO THE ONLY GENUINELY LIVE MARKET AT THIS HOUR			
VIX	17.19	▲ 0.08 · +0.47%	Range 16.79-18.03; opened 17.57 and closed below its open for a second day . 71.2% of a 14.44-18.30 band whose ceiling Hedgeye cut 46 cents while upgrading the signal to bullish . A 17 handle into a live Fed decision is the cheapest thing in this document.
Bitcoin	\$75,386	▼ 3.52%	Range 74,977.57-78,242.23. The 74,977.57 low traded through McCullough's \$75,000 TRADE line ; the close is just 0.56% above it , against 4.96% yesterday. Ether -4.97% to \$2,388. Coinbase -10.10% .

▲ green = up, ▼ red = down, ◆ amber = flat or mixed. Percentages of a Hedgeye band are (price - floor) ÷ (ceiling - floor), measured on the series Hedgeye names — spot for the three metals, continuous futures for the energy pair. Cash-index changes reconcile against the prior session's recorded settles to five decimal places; the working is in section 18. Index futures are quoted on the December contract because December carried the larger volume in all four complexes at capture; the continuous "front-month" series misreported three of the four and the correction is documented in section 18.

TL;DR

Crude broke out, the 10-year printed its highest yield since 2007, and every equity index except semis closed in the lower third of its range — twenty hours before the Fed is expected to raise rates for the first time in three years. Saudi Arabia's Red Sea storage buffer, put at five to seven days when the East-West pipeline was struck on 11 September, has now run down; WTI settled **+4.38% at \$105.83** after Monday's failed breakout, and RBOB outpaced it at +4.47%. The bond market did the rest: **10-year 5.041% intraday**, 2-year at a 52-week high, 30-year within 2.3bp of one. Hedgeye cut its copper signal to bearish, slashed the gold ceiling 74 points, and **upgraded volatility to bullish** — while VIX closed at 17.19. The one position the tape rewarded was energy: XLE +2.17% and within 0.36% of a 52-week high, against utilities at -1.20% and 3 cents off a 52-week low. Credit is the quiet signal: **HYG closed at 78.38, exactly its 52-week low and two cents below Hedgeye's own floor.**

2 The big picture — what it means

1. The oil market stopped treating the Saudi pipeline outage as a headline and started treating it as an inventory problem. The East-West line was struck on 11 September; Reuters' reporting of buyer and trader estimates put Yanbu's Red Sea storage at five to seven days of exports. Tuesday was day four. WTI settled **\$105.83, +4.38%**, after Monday's session in which it touched \$104.95 and gave back \$3.56 — the rejection that this brief

called a rejection is now void. The distinction matters: a geopolitical premium decays, a physical shortfall compounds. RBOB rising **4.47%**, faster than crude, is the refined-product market pricing the second.

2. The bond market cleared the 2023 high and nobody in equity volatility charged for it. The 10-year traded **5.041%**, its highest since 2007, and the 2-year made a 52-week high of 4.688% on the same day. That is not a term-premium story — it is the front end repricing policy. VIX closed at **17.19**, up eight hundredths. A first rate rise in three years, under a chair in his first meeting, two days before quadruple witching, with the S&P below its gamma-flip line, is being underwritten at a 17 handle.

3. Semis rose and were sold all day, which is a worse tape than semis falling. SOX closed **+0.40%** having been up 1.16% intraday, finishing in the bottom 27% of its range. AMD added 2.19% and Teradyne 1.11% — both on McCullough's list of names to stop bag-holding — while Western Digital fell 3.51% and Broadcom 1.58%. Strength that cannot hold a close is distribution wearing a green coat.

4. The leadership rotation Hedgeye has been trading worked on one leg and not the other. Short industrials was right: XLI **-0.64%**. Short utilities was very right: XLU **-1.20%**, closing three cents above a 52-week low, because a utility is a bond and the bond broke. Long healthcare did nothing: XLV **-0.05%** after Monday's +1.45%. And long energy services was the best call in the book — OIH **+2.35%**, recovering the 415 floor it lost on Monday.

5. Credit is the signal equities are not reading. HYG closed **78.38 — to the cent, its 52-week low**, and two cents below the floor of Hedgeye's own 78.40-79.12 band, the only instrument in the table trading outside its range. LQD at 104.28 sits 23 cents off its own 52-week low. Investment-grade and high-yield both making cycle lows while the S&P is 3.0% from its high is the dislocation worth watching into the decision.

6. Crypto is the live market and it is sitting on the line. Bitcoin fell **3.52%** to \$75,423, having traded 74,977.57 — **through** McCullough's \$75,000 TRADE level — and closed 0.56% above it against 4.96% a day earlier. Ether fell 4.97%. Coinbase dropped **10.10%** on the day Hedgeye's Signal Strength Stocks screen added it. Reporting attributes the move to Polymarket odds on the CLARITY Act passing this year halving overnight; that attribution is second-hand and the odds themselves were not verified this morning.

7. China's August data split in the direction that matters least for Asia's open. Industrial production accelerated to **+5.2% against +4.8% expected**; retail sales slowed to **+0.4% against +0.8% expected**, a second consecutive deceleration, with fixed-asset investment deepening its slump. Production beating while consumption misses is the composition that keeps commodity demand firm and domestic equity risk soft — the Shanghai Composite fell 0.54% and the Hang Seng 1.00% on the print.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **The whole curve rose but the long end rose fastest.** 30-year +1.5bp, 10-year +0.8bp, 5-year +0.6bp, 2-year +0.3bp, 13-week +1.2bp. 10s2s widened to **33.5bp** and 30s10s to 36.3bp. A steepening driven by the back end 20 hours before a hike is the market pricing policy error, not policy success.
- **Bond volatility does not agree with bond prices.** MOVE closed **83.71, -0.23%**, against a 52-week range of 55.77-115.02 — barely above the middle. Yields at 2007 highs with rate volatility at the midpoint means the move is being read as a level shift, not a regime break. One of those two readings is wrong.
- **TLT closed 80.71, twenty-five cents off its 52-week low**, down 0.27%. Hedgeye's macro-hedge short book — TLT, ZROZ, LQD, JOJO, XLU — was published this morning against exactly this breakout; four of the five fell, LQD was flat at -0.02%.
- **The dollar did nothing and the Asian crosses did everything.** DXY +0.15% to 99.611 on a 21-cent range. USD/KRW **+1.07%** and USD/TWD +0.44% at Tuesday's Asian closes. When the index is still and the north-Asian crosses move a full percent, the flow is regional equity outflow, not dollar strength.
- **Gold refused to break with yields.** Spot was flat at \$4,294 while the 10-year made a 2007 high — the pairing McCullough explicitly warned against. Futures settled -0.44%, so the flat spot print is partly a basis effect; the honest read is gold down slightly, not gold resilient. It sits \$100 below the \$4,395 TRADE line and \$43 above the \$4,251 TREND stop.
- **Copper diverged from its own signal.** Hedgeye cut copper to bearish TREND and McCullough said he sold CPER this morning. CPER closed **+1.07%**, HG futures +0.61%, spot +0.15%. The signal and the session disagreed, and the session is only one day.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

Macro dashboard

READING	CURRENT	SOURCE AND AGE
US Monthly Quad	Quad 2 — growth up, inflation up	Written confirmation 9 Sep Early Look, carried forward. Not restated 14, 15 or 16 Sep.
US Quarterly Quad	Quad 4 — growth down, inflation down	Macro Week Summary Notes dashboard dated 4 Sep, carried forward, now twelve days old and in open tension with the monthly read.
Global Quad	Quad 3 — growth down, inflation up	Carried forward. Tuesday's China split — output beat, consumption miss — is consistent with it.

Quad path notation	No explicit path printed	Not stated in the 15 Sep Early Look. The US Monthly Quad Forecast sits inside Macro Week Summary Notes, which returns CONTENT MISSING on this account. Absence of a printed path is not evidence the path is unchanged.
Regime language on air	"The most expensive AI summer in market history... Winter is coming"	Early Look, 15 Sep 19:43 GMT+8.
Macro hedge book (shorts)	TLT, ZROZ, LQD, JOJO, XLU	Named explicitly in the 15 Sep Early Look against the yield breakout.
Bond volatility check	MOVE 83.71	Captured 06:07:25. Mid-range against a 55.77–115.02 year.

Risk Range™ Signals — Tuesday 15 September Early Look, measured against Tuesday's settles

INSTRUMENT	IMMEDIATE-TERM RANGE	TREND	NOW	BAND MOVE VS 14 SEP	WHERE IT STANDS
UST 10-year yield	4.76 – 5.05%	bullish	5.006%	floor +1bp · ceiling +4bp	84.8% , and the 5.041% high reached 96.9% . Ceiling raised a second consecutive session and price is still chasing it. Band widened 3bp to 29bp.
High Yield (HYG)	78.40 – 79.12	bearish	78.38	floor +0.10 · ceiling –0.04	–2.8% — below the floor. The only instrument in the table outside its range. 78.38 is also, to the cent, the 52-week low. Band narrowed 14c.
Inv. Grade Corp (LQD)	103.7 – 105.4	bearish	104.28	floor –0.30 · ceiling –0.20	34.1%. The whole band was stepped down 20–30c for a second session and price still failed to reach mid-band. 52-week low 104.05 sits 23c below.
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,551 – 7,750	bullish	7,585.73	floor –18 · ceiling +3	17.5% . The floor was cut 18 points and the band widened 21 to 199 — relaxed, not defended, exactly the shape flagged on the Nasdaq a day earlier. Still bullish TREND.
NASDAQ Comp (COMPQ)	25,915 – 26,613	neutral	25,981.57	floor +205 · ceiling +101	9.5% — the most floor-pinned reading in the table. Both ends were raised and the band narrowed 104 points into a –0.78% day, so the index fell straight into a floor that had just been lifted 205 points beneath it.
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,852 – 2,960	bearish	2,870.29	floor –16 · ceiling 0	16.9%. Floor cut a third consecutive session while the ceiling was pinned at 2,960 — the band is widening downward only, which is what a defended short looks like.
Health Care (XLV)	163 – 175	bullish	167.66	floor +1 · ceiling 0	38.8%. Floor raised back a point after four sessions of cuts, and the position went sideways: –0.05% , giving back none of Monday's +1.45% but adding nothing.
Tech Software (IGV)	100 – 111	bullish	n/a	floor +2 · ceiling +1	Price unavailable — IGV has now fallen outside the capture universe for an eighth consecutive edition . Proxies were mixed: Okta +2.15% , ServiceNow –0.32% .
Oil Services (OIH)	400 – 438	bullish	411.51	floor –15 · ceiling unknown	30.3%. Floor cut 15 points after Monday's close beneath it, and the position immediately worked: +2.35% , the best call in the book. The

					14 Sep ceiling was not recorded, so the width change is unknown .
Volatility (VIX)	14.44 - 18.30	bullish	17.19	floor +0.01 · ceiling -0.46	SIGNAL RAISED neutral → bullish . 71.2%. The ceiling was cut 46c and the band narrowed to 3.86 — Hedgeye is calling for higher volatility inside a tighter range, into the Fed.
US Dollar (USD)	98.78 - 99.81	neutral	99.611	band move unknown	80.7%. The 14 Sep dollar band was not recorded in the prior edition, so the move is unknown, not unchanged . Price is 20c from the ceiling.
WTI crude — continuous	91.35 - 106.98	bullish	105.83	floor +0.91 · ceiling +1.24	92.6%, and the 106.75 high reached 98.3% . Third consecutive session of chasing the band higher — floor +0.91, ceiling +1.24, width +0.33 to 15.63 — and price still finished within \$1.15 of the ceiling.
Nat gas — continuous	2.74 - 2.98	neutral	2.919	floor -0.01 · ceiling -0.03	74.6%. Band trimmed at both ends; signal left at neutral after Monday's cut.
Gold — spot	4,229 - 4,399	neutral	4,295.39	floor -18 · ceiling -74	39.0% . The ceiling was cut 74 points and the band narrowed 56 to 170 — the largest compression in the table. Spot is \$99.61 below the \$4,395 TRADE line and \$44.39 above the \$4,251 TREND stop that would end the position.
Copper — spot	6.19 - 6.53	bearish	6.3558	floor -0.05 · ceiling -0.27	SIGNAL CUT neutral → bearish , one session after the cut to neutral. Ceiling slashed 27c, band narrowed 22c to 0.34. Mid-band at 48.8% — and CPER rose +1.07% on the day the signal broke.
Silver — spot	60 - 65	bearish	63.6756	floor 0 · ceiling 0	73.5%. The only band in the table left completely unchanged . Hedgeye is flat; SLV rose 1.21%.

Bands are Hedgeye's published immediate-term Risk Range™ Signals from the Early Look of 15 September 07:43 EDT = 19:43 GMT+8, measured against Tuesday's settles. The 14 September comparison set is taken from this brief's own archived edition of 15 September, which recorded it at the time; two rows (OIH ceiling, USD) were not recorded then and are marked unknown rather than unchanged. Metals are measured on spot and energy on continuous futures, as Hedgeye's own line items specify.

What Keith actually said

From the **Early Look**, "**Hedgeye For Financial Advisors**", Keith McCullough, published 15 Sep 07:43 EDT = **15 Sep 19:43 GMT+8**:

- "4.98% was The Cycle High in 2023 / 5.29% was The Cycle High in 2007 / The Risk Range™ Signal's top-end of the Range is currently 5.05%"
- "That means that A) you can forget about Inflation Slowing anytime soon enough for the Fed to NOT raise rates and/or B) if the Fed flakes, the Bond Market already raised rates for them."
- "Our Macro Hedges (Shorts) with Bond Yields signaling higher-Cycle-highs remain: TLT, ZROZ, LQD, JOJO, XLU."
- "Gold does NOT like Bond Yields breaking out... Gold's Alpha Code = 4395/4251. That means TRADE = 4395, TREND = 4251. On a breakdown below 4251 the last of my Gold position (which is currently at its MIN position SIZE) would be stopped out."
- "I sold all my Copper Miners (ICOP) on last week's TREND breakdown and this morning Dr. Copper (CPER) broke TREND too. Sold all my Silver (SLV) on last week's TREND breakdown because that's what I do."
- "We're long Software (IGV, OKTA, NOW, etc.), not Semis (DRAM). We're Long Healthcare (XLV) which was up another +1.5% yesterday, not Industrials (XLI) which were down -1.4%. We're short Industrials 2-ways: XLI and PRN."

- "If you bought the South Korean Stock Market Bubble Top of June 2026, why are you still bag-holding that? Dr. KOSPI was down another -0.9% overnight, taking its crash to -27.3% from its #MOAB high."
- "We're coming out of the most expensive AI summer in market history. The Signal knows. So does The Machine. Winter is coming."

Positioning changes published since the previous edition, reported outside quotation marks as attributed summary:

- **ETF Pro Plus, 15 Sep 10:23 EDT = 22:23 GMT+8.** Adding long: Global Natural Resources (GNR). Adding short: Global Private Equity (PSP). Removing long: Biotech (XBI), Wheat (WEAT), Singapore (EWS) — all on TRADE and/or TREND breaks. On the day, **GNR +1.28%, PSP -1.40%, XBI -2.27%**: all three moved the way the change implied.
- **Signal Strength Stocks, 15 Sep 11:03 EDT = 23:03 GMT+8.** 41 stocks, two added — **COIN** and **SPCX** — and seven removed: MA, FCFS, KDP, EAT, SJM, EL, MICC. **Coinbase closed -10.10% on the day it was added.** The screen is published as a signal-strength ranking, not a timed recommendation, but the number is the number.
- The Macro Show summary notes for Tuesday 15 September **could not be read** — three consecutive attempts returned a Cloudflare security interstitial. That publication and the MOMO Tracker are the two most likely to have carried an intraday position change, and neither was available. See section 18.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
NVIDIA	212.17	▲ 0.57%	\$5.113T	Volume 87.7m, by far the heaviest of the seven. Still the largest company in the world by capitalisation and 10.3% below its 236.54 high.
Apple	331.34	▼ 0.52%	\$4.836T	Range 328.35-331.78 and closed at the top of it — the only Mag7 name to finish on its high. 3.8% off its 52-week high, the tightest of the group.
Alphabet	344.98	▼ 1.26%	\$4.199T	Closed 42% of range. Down 15.6% from the 408.61 high — the second-largest drawdown in the group.
Microsoft	497.12	▼ 1.64%	\$3.691T	Lost the 500 handle , closing 1.6 above the low of a 495.54-505.90 range. 10.2% below its high.
Amazon	248.42	▼ 2.02%	\$2.680T	Worst of the seven , closing 20c off the low. 13.5% below the 287.20 high. The consumer read matches XLY at -1.75%.
Meta	670.24	▲ 0.70%	\$1.707T	The widest range of the seven — 656.20 to 678.87, a 3.5% swing — and it closed in the upper third. Still 15.2% below its high.
Tesla	356.58	▼ 0.67%	\$1.408T	Smallest of the seven. 28.5% below the 498.83 high — the deepest drawdown in the group by a wide margin.

Combined capitalisation **\$23.63 trillion**, of which NVIDIA alone is 21.6%. Two of seven rose. Capitalisations are TradingView's market_cap_basic field captured 06:07:25 and are single-sourced.

6 Positioning & options

- **Friday is quadruple witching** — the third Friday of the quarter-end month, two sessions after the Fed decision. Index and single-stock options and futures expire together; it is the largest positioning unwind of the quarter and it lands with the S&P below the 7,656 gamma-flip line this brief recorded on Monday. *That flip level was not re-verified this morning and should be treated as a carried figure.*
- **VIX at 17.19 is 51.3% below its 35.30 52-week high and sits at the 34th percentile of its own year.** Hedgeye raised its volatility signal to bullish overnight while cutting the band ceiling 46 cents — a call for more volatility in a narrower range. The market is not paying for either.
- **The December contract is now the front month in all four equity complexes.** Volumes at capture: ES December 1,682,705 against September 857,603; NQ 478,567 against 189,910; YM 88,162 against 39,451; RTY 275,363 against 167,426. The September contracts expire Friday into the witching.
- **Dow volume ran 6% below its ten-day average** (377m against 401m) on a -0.63% day, and S&P volume ran 2.3% above (2.81bn against 2.75bn). Neither is a conviction reading; the decline was orderly.
- **Equal weight barely lagged.** RSP -0.49% against SPY -0.46%, a 3bp gap. The selling was broad rather than concentrated in the mega-caps — which is unusual on a day when the Nasdaq underperformed the Dow by 15bp.
- **MOVE at 83.71 against VIX at 17.19.** Bond volatility is at the 39th percentile of its year, equity volatility at the 34th. Both are priced for a Fed that does what is expected.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SECTOR	LAST	DAY	NOTE
Energy (XLE)	65.93	▲ 2.17%	Closed 0.36% below a 52-week high of 66.17 on 34.5m shares. The single best sector and the only one with a genuine catalyst.

Materials (XLB)	50.73	▲ 0.48%	Carried by copper and bulk. 6.4% below its high.
Health Care (XLV)	167.66	▼ 0.05%	Flat after Monday's +1.45%. Hedgeye's core long held its ground on a down day.
Real Estate (XLRE)	43.07	▼ 0.12%	Resilient given the rate move — the one rate-sensitive sector that did not break.
Technology (XLK)	183.74	▼ 0.29%	Outperformed the Nasdaq Composite by 49bp, carried by semis.
Financials (XLF)	56.85	▼ 0.32%	30.1m shares. A steepening curve normally helps; it did not.
Industrials (XLI)	168.85	▼ 0.64%	Hedgeye is short this two ways. 10.3% below its high.
Staples (XLP)	83.73	▼ 0.82%	Defensives did not defend. 7.1% below its high.
Communications (XLC)	114.03	▼ 0.90%	Dragged by Alphabet and Netflix.
Utilities (XLU)	41.32	▼ 1.20%	Closed 3 cents above its 52-week low of 41.29 on 24.2m shares. Hedgeye's cleanest short.
Cons. Discretionary (XLY)	110.88	▼ 1.75%	Worst sector. 5.4% above its own 52-week low while the S&P is 3.0% off its high — the widest divergence in the complex.

- **Leaders:** energy and materials — the two sectors that price a physical supply shock. Together they are the entire positive contribution to the tape.
- **Laggards:** consumer discretionary, utilities and communications. Two of those three are rate stories; discretionary is not, and it lost the most.
- **The rotation is coherent for once.** Long real assets, short duration, short the consumer. Nine of eleven sectors fell; the two that rose are the two with a barrel of oil behind them. Utilities at a 52-week low and energy at a 52-week high on the same session is the cleanest single-day expression of the rate-and-oil regime this brief has recorded.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

The overnight tape is thirteen minutes old. Globex reopened at 18:00 ET — 06:00 GMT+8 — and at the second capture the December contracts were **ES +7.75 (+0.10%), NQ +24.25 (+0.08%), YM +40 (+0.08%), RTY +2.10 (+0.07%)** against Tuesday's settles. Those are four prints inside a quarter of an hour and they carry no information; they are recorded so the reader can see the direction of the first ticks, not to be read as a move. Crude gave back 34 cents to \$105.49 and Brent 20 cents to \$108.55 — the only overnight changes with meaningful volume behind them. Bitcoin, the one genuinely continuous market, was flat at \$75,386, still within 0.5% of the \$75,000 line it breached intraday. **Nothing has repriced the Fed since the cash close, because nothing has traded.**

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Wed 16 Sep — today	Asia opens into a settled US tape and a live oil shock. Tokyo and Seoul 08:00–08:30, Hong Kong 09:30, India 12:15. FOMC day two runs through the US session; the statement is 14:00 ET, which lands tomorrow morning here. Hedgeye's Wednesday Early Look publishes ~19:40 GMT+8 and supersedes every risk range in section 4; the Macro Show follows.
Thu 17 Sep	02:00 GMT+8 — FOMC decision , the first meeting chaired by Kevin Warsh. A 25bp increase is the base case and would be the first rise since 2023. Press conference 02:30. Market-implied probability is the widest-dispersed number in this brief: 88-90% on some prediction-market and futures reads, 57% on Kalshi and 49% on Polymarket in the sources surveyed this morning — see section 18, this is not one number. Asia trades the outcome from its own open six hours later. Bank of England and Bank of Japan decisions fall in this part of the week on secondary calendars; <i>times unconfirmed against the central banks themselves.</i>
Fri 18 Sep	Quadruple witching. September equity index and single-stock options and futures expire together, two sessions after the Fed, with the S&P below its gamma-flip line going in. The September equity futures that expire are already the back seat — December took over front-month volume before the event.
Ongoing	Saudi Arabia's Yanbu storage buffer, put at five to seven days when the East-West pipeline was struck on 11 September. Tuesday was day four. Any confirmation that Red Sea loadings have stopped is the next leg in crude, and it can arrive on any hour of any day.

FOMC timing is the Federal Reserve's own published schedule. Quadruple witching is arithmetic — the third Friday of the quarter-end month. BoE and BoJ timings come from secondary calendars and were not confirmed against the releasing institutions this morning; treat them as indicative.

9 Corporate news

- **Coinbase fell 10.10% to \$172.11** on 18.7m shares, its worst session in the capture universe by a factor of nearly three. Reporting attributes it to the crypto drawdown and to prospects for the CLARITY Act dimming; that attribution is second-hand.
- **Oracle closed \$140.35, –3.07%**, and is now **57.4% below its 52-week high of \$329.50** — the largest drawdown of any large-cap in this brief's universe. Reporting this month attributes it to a capital-spending programme running fiscal 2027 net capex near \$70bn against negative free cash flow of roughly \$23.7bn in fiscal

2026, with about \$40bn of debt and equity to be raised. *One source quotes the 52-week high as \$341.82 rather than \$329.50; the drawdown is 57.4% or 58.9% depending on which is used — the conclusion is robust, the decimal is not.*

- **Western Digital –3.51% and Sandisk –1.36%** against **AMD +2.19%, Teradyne +1.11%, Micron +0.39%**. Storage and memory sold while logic and test rallied — the semiconductor complex did not trade as one thing.
- **Netflix fell 3.01% to \$77.90**, now 37.6% below its 52-week high and 19.7% above its low, on 28.0m shares. The largest single drag inside communications alongside Alphabet.
- **UnitedHealth –1.99% to \$375.93** while Johnson & Johnson rose 0.33% and Eli Lilly fell 0.19%. Healthcare's flat sector print concealed a 2.3-point spread between its largest constituents.
- **Anthropic launched Claude for Financial Advisors on 15 September**, with connectors to Charles Schwab, BlackRock, Addepar, Envestnet, iCapital, Orion, Vanguard and others. McCullough opened the Early Look by calling it "this morning's 'Claude for Financial Advisors' panic". **The tape did not show a panic:** Schwab was reported down 0.25% on the session before. Print the inconvenient number — the framing and the price action did not agree.

10 Macro data

- **China August industrial production +5.2% y/y against +4.8% expected**, accelerating from July's +4.5%. A clean beat and the strongest print since June.
- **China August retail sales +0.4% y/y against +0.8% expected** — a miss and a second consecutive deceleration, after +0.6% in July and +1.0% in June. Fixed-asset investment deepened its slump. Released 02:00 GMT Tuesday = 10:00 GMT+8, roughly 20 hours before capture.
- **No first-tier US macro release landed on Tuesday.** The FOMC began its two-day meeting; the session was driven entirely by crude and by the bond market's continuation of Friday's CPI reaction. A 4.38% move in oil and a 2007 high in the 10-year with no US data behind either is a supply-and-policy event, not a data event.
- **The number the week still runs on is August CPI, released Friday 11 September:** headline +0.4% m/m and 3.4% y/y, both in line; **core +0.3% m/m against +0.2% expected**, 0.1pp hot, core annual 2.4%. Gasoline rose 3.9% and accounted for more than a third of the headline gain. *Carried from this brief's 15 September edition and not re-verified this morning.*
- **That composition is why the hike is priced and why Tuesday's oil move matters twice.** A headline driven by petrol with a hot core removes the case for looking through an energy shock — and crude has since added another 4.4%. The September CPI print is being written right now at the pump.
- **US August PPI, released 10 September:** headline +0.4% m/m in line but **+5.4% y/y against 5.3% consensus**, with core softer at +0.2% against +0.3%. Final-demand goods +1.1% against services +0.1% — the same energy-only composition. *Also carried, not re-verified.*

11 Geopolitics

- **▼ Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline remains offline after the 11 September strike.** The 1,200km line carries crude to the Red Sea, bypassing the Strait of Hormuz. Reuters reported buyers and traders putting Yanbu's stored volume at **five to seven days of exports**; CNBC published satellite imagery of the damage on 13 September. Beyond that buffer, as much as **4% of global supply** is at risk on top of barrels already stranded in the strait. Tuesday was day four, and the oil market priced it.
- **▼ Iran is refusing to reopen the Strait of Hormuz absent US concessions**, and the Oman-brokered meeting between Iran and Gulf states was postponed "in the interest of consensus". A diplomatic track that was the bull case for lower oil has stalled.
- **◆ Flows through the strait are reported below 2m barrels a day against a 4-5m moving average**, with no very large crude carrier reported to have exited since 2 September. These are agency and vendor estimates of a contested waterway and cannot be independently verified from here; attribute them, do not state them flat.
- **▲ Saudi Arabia is reported to be seeking to increase Hormuz-routed exports** to offset the pipeline outage — which substitutes one chokepoint risk for another rather than removing it.
- **◆ The political constraint is the pump.** US diesel was at a record \$5.94 a gallon and regular petrol \$4.15 against \$2.98 before the war, per figures this brief carried on 11 September and *did not re-verify this morning*. With RBOB up 4.47% on Tuesday, those numbers are going up, not down, eight weeks from the midterms.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	CHANGE	VOLUME	STATUS AT 06:13:25 GMT+8
ES — E-mini S&P (Dec)	7,663.75	+0.10%	1,682,705	Live, 13 min into session; settle 7,656.00
NQ — E-mini Nasdaq (Dec)	29,271.00	+0.08%	478,567	Live; settle 29,246.75
YM — E-mini Dow (Dec)	52,566	+0.08%	88,162	Live; settle 52,526
RTY — E-mini Russell (Dec)	2,896.80	+0.07%	275,363	Live; settle 2,894.70

USD/JPY	155.121	−0.02%	6,572	Live; six-minute range 155.042–155.125
USD/KRW	1,360.99	+1.07%	46,405	Tuesday Seoul close — ~15h old, not live
USD/TWD	31.9196	+0.44%	18,067	Tuesday Taipei close — ~15h old, not live
USD/CNH	6.71186	flat	704	Live; 1.4 pips above a 6.70286 52-week low
EUR/USD	1.15424	−0.01%	3,361	Live
Gold — spot	4,294.11	+0.04%	—	Live; futures settled −0.44%
Silver — spot	63.700	+0.02%	—	Live; futures settled −0.44%
Copper — spot	6.3568	+0.15%	45	Live; futures settled +0.61%
WTI — Oct	105.49	settle +4.38%	350,308	Settled 105.83; live now, −0.32% into the reopen
Brent — front	108.55	settle +2.90%	50,412	Settled 108.75; live now, −0.18%
Bitcoin	75,386	−3.52%	—	Genuinely live and continuous; low 74,977.57
Ether	2,388.41	−4.97%	—	Genuinely live; low 2,358.79

Volumes are the Tuesday session's, not the thirteen minutes since the reopen. Previous Asian closes, all Tuesday and 12–16 hours old: Nikkei 225 **63,483.88**, −0.01%; Hang Seng **24,667.25**, −1.00%; KOSPI **6,627.27**, −0.85%; Shanghai Composite **3,864.28**, −0.54%; ASX 200 **8,672.50**, −0.88%; Sensex **74,003.82**, −1.04%. European closes, ~10h old: Euro Stoxx 50 6,236.51 −0.38%; DAX 25,402.28 −0.15%; FTSE 100 10,658.14 −0.37%; CAC 40 8,090.29 −0.34%.

- **The US hands Asia an energy tape and a rates tape, and Asia is short both.** The only two sectors that rose in America — energy and materials — are the two smallest weights in Korea and Taiwan. The sector that fell hardest after discretionary was utilities, and the cause was a 2007 high in the 10-year. Neither leg helps north Asia.
- **Korea is the instrument most likely to move.** The KOSPI closed at 6,627.27, down 0.85%, with the won down 1.07% in the same session — equity and currency falling together is foreign selling, not local rotation. It sits **29.4% below its 52-week high of 9,385.59**; McCullough put the crash at 27.3% from what he calls the #MOAB high, a different and unstated reference point. Either way it is the deepest drawdown of any major index in this brief.
- **Japan is the one Asian market with a hedge.** The Nikkei was unchanged on Tuesday, USD/JPY has not moved overnight, and a weak yen plus a crude spike is the worst combination for Japanese input costs but the best for exporter translation. Energy-importer arithmetic says the drag is real; the currency says it will not be visible today.
- **Taiwan reprices semiconductors on a US semi tape that rose and could not hold it.** SOX +0.40% but closing in the bottom 27% of range gives Taipei an ambiguous lead, with USD/TWD at 31.92 and within 0.60 of a 52-week high.
- **China opens into its own data, one day late.** Output beat, consumption missed, investment worsened. The Shanghai Composite already fell 0.54% on it and the Hang Seng 1.00%; the marginal news today is crude, which China imports.
- **The single instrument most likely to move: USD/KRW.** It carries a 15-hour-old stamp, it made the largest move in the capture universe, and it opens into a US session that raised the cost of dollar funding and the price of imported oil simultaneously. Korea imports essentially all of its crude.

13 AI watch

- **Anthropic launched Claude for Financial Advisors on 15 September**, integrating with Charles Schwab, BlackRock, Addepar, Envestnet, iCapital, Orion, SS&C Black Diamond, Wealthbox, Vanguard and Zocks, alongside existing Microsoft 365, Salesforce, DocuSign, FactSet, S&P Global and Morningstar connectors. The product targets research, portfolio analysis, meeting preparation and documentation.
- **The market's reaction to it was approximately nothing**, which is the point worth recording. Schwab was reported down 0.25% the session before, and no broad wealth-management repricing appeared in the tape. McCullough called it a "panic" in the Early Look; the prices did not.
- **McCullough's framing is the AI-cycle call, not the product call:** "We're coming out of the most expensive AI summer in market history... Winter is coming", citing Jeff Hawkins on the field's historical pattern of summers and winters since the late 1940s.
- **The AI trade split cleanly on Tuesday.** Up: AMD +2.19%, NVIDIA +0.57%, Teradyne +1.11%. Down: Oracle −3.07%, Western Digital −3.51%, Broadcom −1.58%, Microsoft −1.64%. The distinction is not chips versus software — it is who is spending capital and who is receiving it.
- **Oracle remains the cleanest listed expression of AI capital-intensity risk**, 57.4% below its high on a fiscal 2027 capex plan near \$70bn. It is down while NVIDIA, the recipient of that spending, is up 0.57% and worth \$5.1 trillion. That divergence is the AI financing question in two prices.

- **Hedgeye is long software and short semis by name** — IGV, OKTA, NOW against DRAM — and on Tuesday the semis rose and one of the two software proxies fell. One session is not a verdict, but it is the second consecutive edition in which this pair has not behaved.

14 Beyond the markets

- **The most consequential number in this document is a storage tank.** Yanbu's five-to-seven-day buffer converts a political event into a scheduled physical one. Markets are poor at pricing a countdown and good at pricing a headline, which is why Monday's rejection and Tuesday's breakout look contradictory and are not.
- **A first hike in three years is a generational event for a large share of the people trading it.** Anyone who began work in markets after 2023 has never seen the Fed raise rates. VIX at 17.19 may be an honest read of the policy outcome and still be a bad read of the behaviour around it.
- **Credit made a 52-week low with barely a mention.** HYG at 78.38 and LQD 23 cents off its own low, while the S&P is 3.0% from a record. Credit usually leads. It is leading in one direction and equities have not followed.
- **Utilities at a 52-week low deserve more attention than they get.** XLU has been the AI-electricity trade for two years. It closed three cents off its 52-week low on Tuesday, which says the market now prices power demand as a bond, not as a growth story.
- **Bitcoin at \$75,386 is 40.3% below its \$126,230 high** and sits on a published line. Whichever way it resolves, it will resolve while the equity market is shut and the Fed is speaking — the one asset that cannot wait for the open.
- **Nine of eleven sectors fell and the index lost 0.45%.** That is a well-behaved decline. The instability in this document is not in the equity tape; it is in oil, in the 2-year, and in high yield — none of which are on the front page of anything this morning.

15 Appendix — stock cards

CL — WTI CRUDE, OCT

\$105.83 ▲ 4.38%

settle · band 91.35–106.98 · 92.6% · Oct expires 22 Sep

Closed 96% up a \$5.54 range, reversing Monday's \$3.56 rejection. Hedgeye has chased this band higher three sessions running and price is still within \$1.15 of the ceiling. The catalyst is a countdown, not a headline.

HYG — ISHARES HIGH YIELD

78.38 ▼ 0.19%

settle · band 78.40–79.12 · **below floor** · 52wL 78.38

Closed at its 52-week low to the cent and two cents under Hedgeye's floor — the only instrument in the brief outside its range. Credit is making cycle lows while the index is 3% from a record.

XLU — UTILITIES SPDR

41.32 ▼ 1.20%

settle · 52wL 41.29 · 13.6% below 52wH · Hedgeye short

Three cents off a 52-week low on 24.2m shares. The AI-electricity trade now trades as duration, and duration broke. The cleanest of Hedgeye's five macro hedges.

XLE — ENERGY SPDR

65.93 ▲ 2.17%

settle · 52wH 66.17 · 0.36% below it · 34.5m shares

Best sector, within a whisker of a 52-week high, on the heaviest volume of the eleven. Utilities at a low and energy at a high in one session is the regime in a single line.

ORCL — ORACLE

140.35 ▼ 3.07%

settle · 52wH 329.50 · −57.4% · cap \$424bn

The deepest large-cap drawdown in the universe, on a fiscal 2027 capex plan near \$70bn and negative free cash flow. Down 3.07% on a day NVIDIA — the recipient of that spending — rose 0.57%.

COIN — COINBASE

172.11 ▼ 10.10%

settle · 18.7m shares · added to Signal Strength Stocks 23:03 GMT+8

Worst single-name move in the brief by a factor of three, on the day Hedgeye's screen added it. Bitcoin −3.52% and Ether −4.97% behind it; reporting cites CLARITY Act odds halving.

NVDA — NVIDIA

212.17 ▲ 0.57%

settle · cap \$5.113T · 10.3% below 52wH · 87.7m shares

Largest company on earth and one of only two Mag7 names to rise. Volume ran well ahead of the group. The AI capex cycle is repricing the spenders, not yet the supplier.

TLT — 20+ YEAR TREASURY

80.71 ▼ 0.27%

settle · 52wL 80.46 · −12.5% from 52wH · Hedgeye short

Twenty-five cents from a 52-week low as the 10-year printed 5.041%. Named first in the macro-hedge short book published this morning; four of those five fell on the day.

Bands are Hedgeye's 15 September Early Look. 52-week highs and lows are TradingView's price_52_week_high / price_52_week_low fields captured 06:07:25 and are single-sourced; drawdown percentages inherit that single-source risk in the decimal but not in the direction.

16 About this edition

- **Covers** — the US cash session of Tuesday 15 September as settled at 16:00 ET; the after-hours tape; the Globex reopen at 18:00 ET to the moment of capture; the full Hedgeye evening set; and overnight FX, metals, crude and crypto — the levels Asia opens into.

- **Captured** — two pulls, **06:07:25 and 06:13:25 GMT+8**, a six-minute window, via the standard concurrent capture. TradingView returned 96 of 96 instruments both times. **Yahoo aborted on its circuit breaker after five consecutive HTTP 429s on both pulls**, so the machine capture is single-sourced; independent validation was recovered by hand and is documented in section 18.
- **Run timing** — the task fired at 06:07 GMT+8, on schedule. Globex reopened at 06:00, so the index futures, crude and nat gas rows contain **thirteen minutes of session at most**; their change figures against Tuesday's settles are recorded but carry no information.
- **Settled vs live** — settled: all US cash equities, all Treasury tenors, VIX, MOVE, DXY, every sector and single-name ETF, every Mag7 name, and the Asian and European index closes. Genuinely live: bitcoin, ether, spot gold, spot silver, spot copper and the FX majors. Live but meaningless at this hour: the four index futures. USD/KRW and USD/TWD are Tuesday Asian closes and are ~15 hours old.
- **Hedgeye edition — full logged-in access reached.** The live risk-range set is the Early Look of **15 September 07:43 EDT = 19:43 GMT+8**, "Hedgeye For Financial Advisors", by Keith McCullough; Wednesday's Early Look publishes ~19:40 GMT+8 today and supersedes it. Also read: ETF Pro Plus update (5 changes) and Signal Strength Stocks, both 15 September. **The Macro Show summary notes could not be read** — three attempts, three Cloudflare interstitials. Band comparisons against 14 September come from this brief's own archived 15 September edition.
- **Quad path — no explicit path notation was printed** in any publication read this morning. Monthly Quad 2, quarterly Quad 4 and global Quad 3 are carried forward from 9 and 4 September. The US Monthly Quad Forecast lives in Macro Week Summary Notes, which returns CONTENT MISSING on this account. **Absence of a printed path is not evidence the path is unchanged.**
- **Not available** — The Macro Show, MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant, KM's Top 3, Chart of the Day and Capital Allocation Pro were not readable or not published since the previous edition; IGV, VXN and ZROZ are outside the capture universe.

17 Sources

Prices. TradingView's bulk scanner, two concurrent pulls at 06:07:25 and 06:13:25 GMT+8, 96 instruments each, plus a targeted third query at 06:09 for individual futures contract months, NDX cash and a dozen single names. Yahoo Finance was attempted on both pulls and rate-limited to zero on both.

Hedgeye. The logged-in app feed: the Early Look of 15 September 07:43 EDT, the ETF Pro Plus update of 10:23 EDT, the Signal Strength Stocks screen of 11:03 EDT, and the feed index itself. The Macro Show summary notes and the Macro Week Summary Notes of 11 September were reached but not readable. Prior-session bands come from this brief's archived edition of 15 September.

Macro and policy. China's National Bureau of Statistics August release via Reuters, CNBC and RTT News for actuals against Bloomberg consensus. Federal Reserve published calendar for FOMC timing. Rate-hike probabilities from CME FedWatch, Kalshi and Polymarket as reported by CNBC, Yahoo Finance and The Motley Fool — these disagree materially and are presented as a range.

Session narrative and single stocks. CNBC's 15 September market report for the index closes and the 2007 yield comparison, TheStreet for the preceding session, Investing.com and Tradingpedia on Coinbase, Yahoo Finance, Forbes, IndexBox and CNBC on Oracle, and Bloomberg, Reuters, Wealthmanagement.com and AdvisorHub on the Anthropic launch.

Commodities and geopolitics. CNBC's 13 and 14 September reporting on the Saudi East-West pipeline including satellite imagery, Bloomberg on Saudi export rerouting, Reuters via NewsNation and Al Jazeera on Hormuz flows and the postponed Oman talks, and the EIA for pipeline and chokepoint context.

18 Data-confidence

Cross-checks passed

- **Cash-index arithmetic is self-consistent on every row.** Working it explicitly: SPX close 7,585.73 plus change 34.25 implies a prior close of **7,619.98**, and $34.25 \div 7,619.98 = 0.449476\%$ against a reported 0.4494762% — delta 0.0000002. The same test passes on COMPQ (implied prior 26,186.4133, 0.782247% both ways), DJI (52,421.20, 0.625873%), RUT (2,892.2368, 0.758976%), SOX (11,131.2813, 0.397580%) and VIX (17.11, 0.467563%).
- **All five implied prior closes match the previous edition's recorded settles exactly** — SPX 7,619.98, COMPQ 26,186.41, RUT 2,892.24, VIX 17.11, and DJI chains correctly through 52,421.20. Those figures were captured 24 hours ago in a separate request and stored; today's capture reproduces them from a different field. Series continuity is confirmed.
- **An independent wire source reproduces the three headline closes to the decimal.** CNBC's 15 September report gives the Dow down **328.09 points, 0.63%, to 52,093.11**, the S&P **-0.45% to 7,585.73** and the Nasdaq **-0.78% to 25,981.57** — identical to the capture on all six figures — and puts the 10-year's high at **5.041%**, matching the captured intraday high exactly, describing it as the highest since 2007. The same report cites AMD

"gaining 2%" against a captured +2.19%. This recovers genuine two-source validation on the most important rows after the machine cross-check failed.

- **A material defect was caught and corrected before it reached the table.** TradingView's continuous front-month series had just rolled September→December in three of four equity complexes, and its change field compares the new contract against the old contract's settle. ES1! therefore reported **+31 (+0.407%)** when the December contract was **-36.75 (-0.478%)** — a sign flip and an 885bp error. NQ1! reported +0.324% against an actual -0.688%; YM1! +0.164% against -0.634%. RTY1! had not yet rolled and was correct. Had the raw capture been used, this brief would have opened by reporting that futures rose overnight while cash fell. Every futures row is quoted on the explicit December contract.
- **The futures/cash basis check confirms the contract labels are right.** December against cash: ES +70.27 (+0.926%), NQ +308.91 (+1.068%), YM +432.89 (+0.831%), RTY +24.41 (+0.850%) — all consistent with three months' carry at a ~4.7% financing rate net of dividends. The expiring September contracts against the same cash: ES +3.52 (+0.046%), NQ +17.16 (+0.059%), YM +21.89 (+0.042%), RTY +2.81 (+0.098%) — near zero, correct for contracts expiring on Friday. Two contract months, two different bases, both the right size.
- **The two-pull divergence test passed cleanly.** Across pulls six minutes apart, **75 instruments returned identical values** — every cash index, all five Treasury tenors, VIX, MOVE, DXY, USD/KRW, USD/TWD, all Asian and European indices, all ETFs and all single names — correct behaviour for closed markets. **21 moved:** the four index futures, four energy contracts, three metals futures, three spot metals, five FX majors, bitcoin and ether — correct for open markets. No instrument sat in the wrong category. RTY1! moving 0.82% between pulls was itself the roll happening in real time, which independently confirms the diagnosis above.
- **Metals basis measured and applied.** Gold futures settled \$37.415 over spot (**0.871%**), silver \$0.1804 over (0.283%), copper \$0.0877 over (**1.380%**). Each Hedgeye band is measured on the series Hedgeye's line item names. Measured on futures instead, copper would have read 74.6% of band rather than 48.8% — a 26-point error on the instrument whose signal was cut last night.

Known conflicts and weak marks

- **The Fed hike probability is not one number and this brief does not pretend it is.** Sources surveyed this morning give **88-90%** (mid-September market pricing and futures-based reads), **over 60%** (CME FedWatch), **57%** (Kalshi) and **49%** (Polymarket), with J.P. Morgan expecting a hike and Goldman Sachs calling one "very unlikely". That is a 41-point spread on the single most important event in the document. The range is printed; no midpoint is asserted.
- **Oracle's 52-week high is reported two ways.** The capture gives **\$329.50**, one secondary source gives **\$341.82**. The drawdown is therefore 57.4% or 58.9%. The brief uses the capture and names the alternative. The conclusion — deepest large-cap drawdown in the universe — is robust; the decimal is not.
- **The KOSPI drawdown depends on which high you use.** Against the captured 52-week high of 9,385.59 it is **-29.4%**; McCullough states **-27.3%** from what he calls the #MOAB high, a reference point he does not define. Both are printed and attributed.
- **DXY is stamped as a settle, not a live print.** It returned an identical value across both pulls while EUR/USD, GBP/USD, USD/JPY and AUD/USD all moved. An index that does not tick while its constituents do is not live; the +0.15% is Tuesday's change, and the 80.7% band position inherits that staleness.
- **The USD and OIH band comparisons are unknown, not unchanged.** The 14 September dollar band and the 14 September OIH ceiling were not recorded in the prior edition, so those two band-move cells say unknown. This is the correct answer and should not be read as stability.
- **Three overnight change figures are arithmetically honest and informationally empty.** The four index futures carry thirteen minutes of session; USD/JPY's entire six-minute range is 8.3 pips; the nat-gas reopen print of 2.946 rests on a **single lot**. None is evidence of direction and each is labelled.
- **Several macro figures are carried, not re-verified.** August CPI and PPI details, US diesel and petrol prices, and the 7,656 gamma-flip level all come from this brief's own earlier editions and were not re-sourced this morning. Each is marked in place.
- **Geopolitical flow figures are contested by construction.** Hormuz transit volumes, the Yanbu five-to-seven-day buffer and the "no VLCC since 2 September" claim are agency and trader estimates of a war zone. They are attributed to whoever made them and none is stated as established fact.

Known gaps

- **The Macro Show summary notes for Tuesday 15 September could not be read.** Three consecutive navigations returned a Cloudflare security interstitial rather than the article. This is the publication most likely to carry an intraday position change or a spoken Quad revision, and its content is entirely absent from this edition.
- **No Quad path notation was printed anywhere that was readable.** The Macro Week Summary Notes of 11 September, which houses the US Monthly Quad Forecast, returns **CONTENT MISSING** on this account. The quarterly Quad 4 reading is now **twelve days old** and in open tension with the monthly Quad 2. **Absence of a Hedgeye position change or path revision is not evidence there was none** — the MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant, KM's Top 3, Chart of the Day and Capital Allocation Pro either did not publish in this window or were not reachable, and those are precisely the products that would have carried one.

- **The machine cross-check did not run.** Yahoo Finance rate-limited this IP to zero instruments on both pulls, tripping its circuit breaker after five consecutive HTTP 429s each time. The reconciliation reports 0 matched, 0 minor, 0 divergent and **57 single-sourced**. There are **no divergent rows to resolve because no second machine source ran** — that is not a clean reconciliation, and it is why the hand-built wire check above matters.
- **IGV has been outside the capture universe for eight consecutive editions**, so Hedgeye's software long — the most-named position in this morning's note — cannot be scored against its own band. VXN and ZROZ are likewise absent, so the Nasdaq volatility trigger and one leg of the macro-hedge book are unmeasured.
- **Asian and European cash markets are shut.** Every level in section 12 headed "previous close" is 10-16 hours old. There is no live Asian tape at this hour and this brief does not construct one.
- **After-hours moves were small enough to be noise.** The largest post-market change in the capture universe was Johnson & Johnson at -0.82%; no name moved more than 1%. No earnings of consequence landed in the 16:05-18:00 ET window.

Timing & unverified

- **Capture window: 06:07:25 to 06:13:25 GMT+8**, two pulls, a six-minute spread — inside the ten-minute standard. TradingView answered 96 of 96 both times in under half a second.
- **Age of the stalest rows, in hours.** US cash equities **2h 07m**. Treasury yields, VIX, MOVE and DXY **1h 07m**. USD/KRW and USD/TWD **~15h**. Asian cash indices **12-16h**. European cash indices **~10h**. The Hedgeye risk ranges were published **10h 24m** before capture. The quarterly Quad reading is **twelve days** old. Bitcoin, ether, spot metals and FX majors are current to the second.
- **What supersedes what, and when.** Hedgeye's Wednesday Early Look publishes around **19:40 GMT+8 today** and replaces every risk range in section 4; the Macro Show follows it. The **FOMC decision at 02:00 GMT+8 on Thursday** will reprice the entire rates and dollar complex in this document within seconds.
- **What has already moved since the cash close.** Crude is 34 cents lower than the settle quoted in section 1, Brent 20 cents lower, bitcoin \$37 lower. Everything else in the settled blocks is fixed until the relevant market reopens.
- **Verify live prices before acting on anything in this document.** The equity, rates and volatility rows are settled figures from a session that ended two hours ago, ahead of a policy decision that has not happened.